diverse nation, but instead promoted greater discord through a hegemonic Islamic discourse that undermined ethnic identities, with different state and non-state actors seeking to provide the 'true' meaning of Islam for the Islamic Republic of Pakistan (Nelson 2009; Rahman 2004). With Pakistan's increasing involvement in the Middle East and the influx of petro dollars in the 1970s and 1980s as Pakistani migrants travelled back and forth to the Gulf, the 'true' meaning of Islam in Pakistan started to take on a more puritanical version of Sunni Islam. Pakistan, the homeland of Muslims, the Land of the Pure, was linked to a larger Muslim Ummah located primarily in the Middle East, a connection that had major repercussions for domestic politics and notions of Pakistani citizenship. This puritanical version of Islam as a defining feature of Pakistani citizenship was reinforced through the education system of the country. While the role of madrassas increased in the 1980s under the patronage of the Saudis and Americans to support Pakistan's war against the Soviet infidel, such Islamic schools were only a fraction of the education system (Winthrop and Graff 2010; Rahman 2004). Instead it was the mainstream education system, and the subsequent Islamization of the national curriculum, that paved the way for a concept of Pakistani citizenship that is immersed in Islamic dogma, where patriotism and loyalty are laced with religious fervour, where the enemy of Pakistan is often seen as an enemy of Islam. After 9/11, and Pakistan's involvement in the 'war on terror', the Musharraf regime under its 'Enlightened Moderation' agenda sought to de-Islamize the education curriculum by focusing on a more inclusive interpretation of Islamic values through the National Curriculum 2006, while mainstreaming madrassas, despite facing opposition, with the aim of fighting extremism under pressure from the United States and its allies. Even though the Musharraf period was followed by democratic rule under the PPP and the PML(N), this chapter illustrates how the de-Islamization of education, especially citizenship education, was far from successful, with young Pakistanis' notion of identity immersed in religious ideology.

The chapter explores the nature of such citizenship for young Pakistanis in modern-day Pakistan. It begins by examining how the education system has been used to promote a discourse of Pakistani citizenship defined by Islam. The first part therefore provides the backdrop to the narratives of young Pakistanis today, by exploring significant policies and curricular reforms that have had a direct impact on citizenship education. The chapter does not provide a historical timeline of events but only highlights policies that were instrumental in the Islamization of the education system, in particular the curriculum for subjects